



AGENT HACKATHON

Microsoft Student Ambassador Program 2026



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WHY EXCHANGE MATTERS

A transformative experience trapped in a fragmented process



5,400+

students go on outbound exchange every year across Hong Kong's 8 UGC-funded universities (2019/20)

Source: Statista / UGC



2,600+

exchange agreements signed by HK's UGC-funded universities with partner institutions worldwide

Source: Times Higher Education, 2024



+23 pts

higher likelihood of employment within 3 years for study-abroad graduates vs. non-mobile peers

Source: IZA World of Labor

⚠ BUT APPLICATION IS A HUSTLE WITH NO CENTRALIZED GUIDANCE

One exchange case need at least 6 sperate login



From our initial survey (N= XX),

33%

are concerned about credit transfer eligibility

"It could affect my graduation timeline if the course credit cannot be transferred"

25%

struggle to meet application deadlines

"I am overwhelmed by a number of deadlines"

17%

fear they may not secure accommodation in time

"I don't know where to look for accommodation, and I'm worried everything affordable will be gone before I apply."

To unlock the full value of exchange, students need a centralized end-to-end platform that guides them from preparation to departure

Pain Points

Solutions

User Journey

Architecture

Implementation Plan

Impacts

SOLUTIONS

Addressing the highest-friction moments across the exchange journey



School Mapping

Matches students with partner universities based on their academic focus, language preference, and destination goals



Host Country Explore

Delivers curated insights on culture, cost of living, safety, climate, and daily life for the chosen host country



Course Mapping

Automatically compares home and host university modules, flagging mismatches and suggesting equivalent alternatives



Interview Preparation

Builds confidence and sharpens responses for visa, university, or scholarship interviews.



Application Planning

Breaks down every deadline, document requirement, and submission step into a personalised, timed checklist

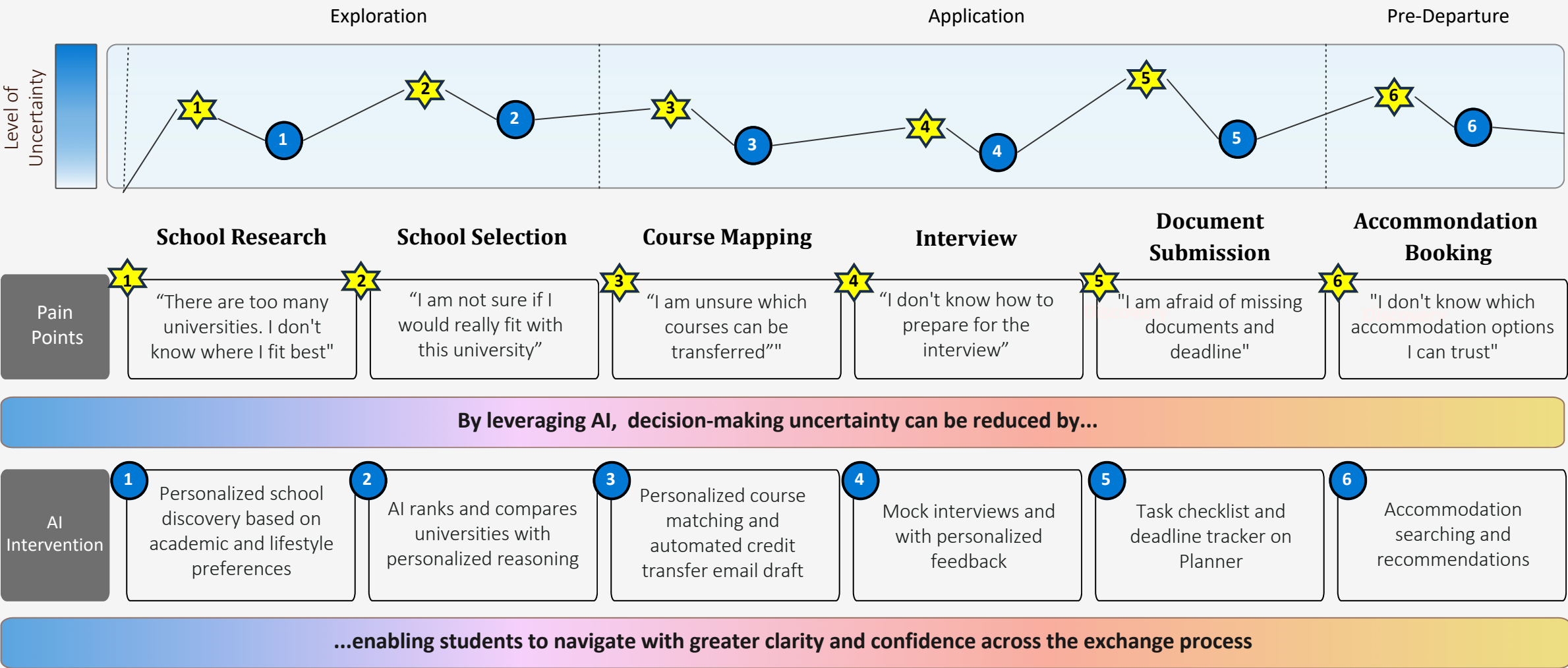


Accommodation Search

Saves weeks of stressful searching and helps students secure safe, affordable housing faster

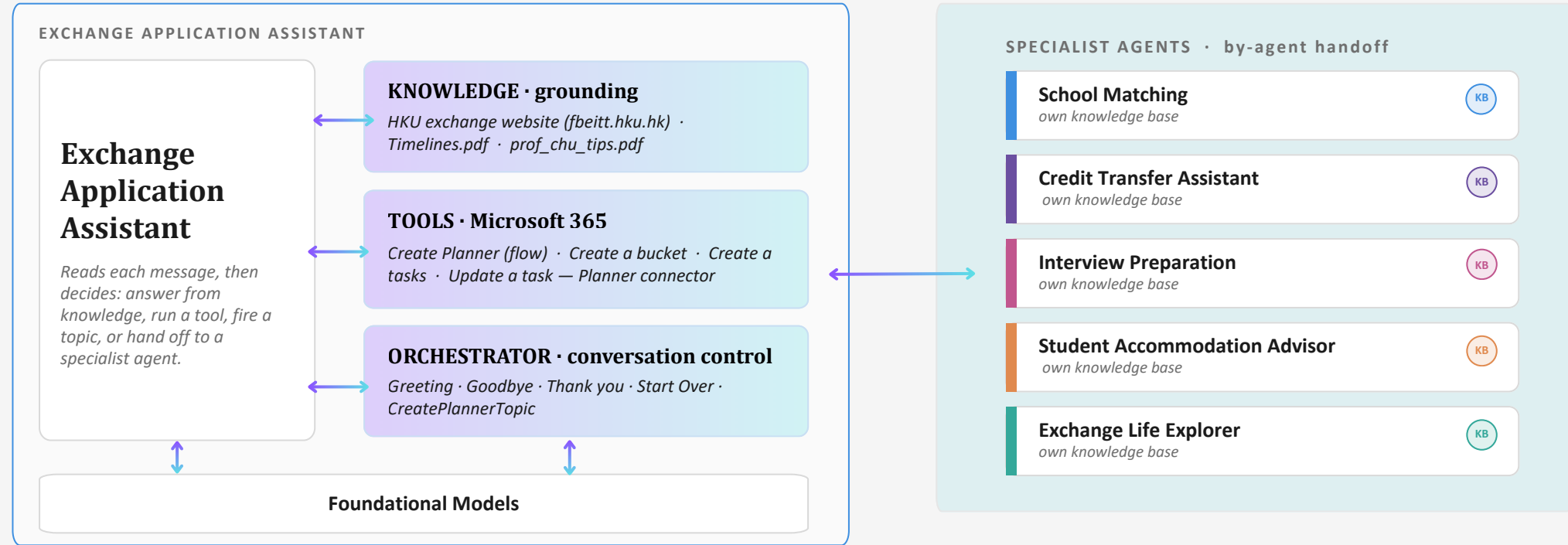
USER JOURNEY

From school discovery to accommodation booking, AI reduces uncertainty at every stage of the exchange journey



AGENT ARCHITECTURE

A modular multi-agent architecture that combines trusted knowledge, workflow automation, and specialized expertise



1

Modular Multi-Agent Design

Domain-specific agents encapsulate distinct business logic and knowledge, enabling higher accuracy, easier maintenance, and scalable feature expansion.

2

Trusted Knowledge Grounding

Agent responses are grounded in verified HKU resources, ensuring consistency, transparency, and reduced hallucination risk.

3

Workflow Automation via Microsoft 365

Planner integration converts recommendations into actionable tasks, creating a seamless bridge between guidance and execution.

4

Orchestrated Request Routing

An orchestration layer classifies user intent and routes requests to the most appropriate topic, tool, or specialist agent for efficient resolution.

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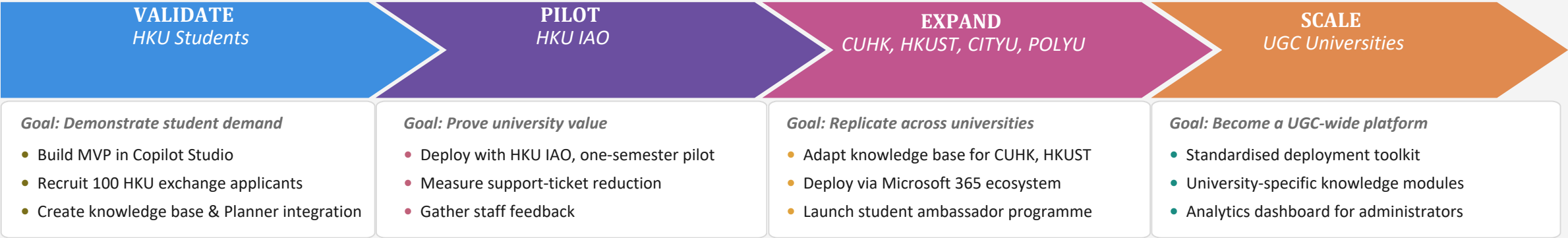
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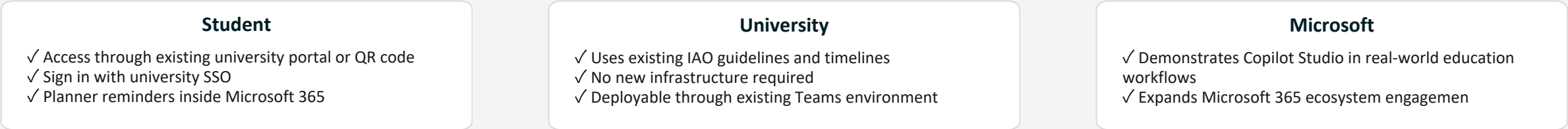
IMPLEMENTATION PLAN

A phased rollout strategy designed to validate demand, prove institutional value, and scale across universities

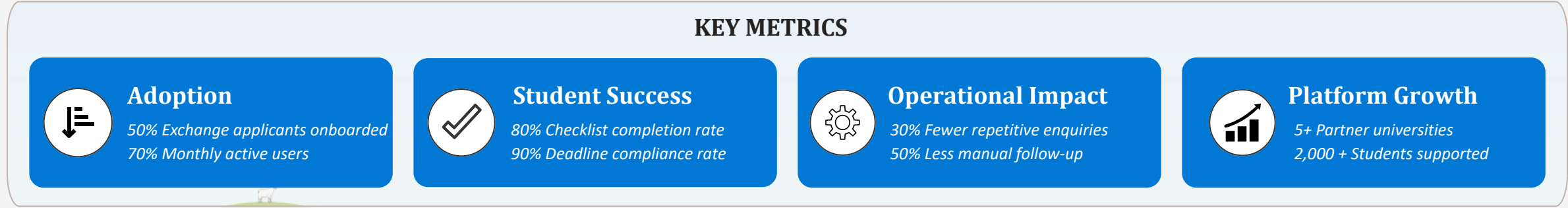


LOW-FRICTION ADOPTION STRATEGY

Seamless Integration with Existing Infrastructure



KEY METRICS



Pain Points

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User Journey

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RISKS& MITIGATION

Scaling responsibly through trust, governance, and control



Risk	Magnitude	Mitigation
1 University Adoption & Institutional Trust Universities may be hesitant to endorse or deploy a student-facing AI assistant due to concerns around reliability, governance, and reputational risk.	Probability Impact	• Demonstrate measurable outcomes before wider deployment • Position the assistant as a support tool rather than a decision-making authority
2 Cross-University Standardization Risk Exchange policies, timelines, and procedures differ across institutions, making it challenging to deploy a single solution consistently.	Probability Impact	• Provide configurable templates for deployment across institutions • Establish governance guidelines for content ownership
3 Privacy, Security & Regulatory Compliance The assistant may process sensitive personal information related to applications, visas, and academic records.	Probability Impact	• Apply role-based access controls and university SSO authentication • Minimize storage of personally identifiable information (PII)
4 Student Adoption & Behaviour Change Students may continue relying on informal channels such as Reddit, WhatsApp groups, or peer advice instead of the assistant.	Probability Impact	• Embed access directly into existing student touchpoints (exchange portal, Teams, QR codes) • Launch a peer ambassador programme to drive awareness